the social and governance agenda.

India Should Set Her Environmental Goals Clearly

India does not have any specific law to combat climate change though it has a comprehensive and intrusive environmental protection law that deals with environmental pollution. The environmental problems of India are so massive that it would be impossible for the government to deal with every polluting element. However, climate change and environmental pollution can be handled more effectively if we were to focus on some specific pollutants.

There are five such major pollutants:

First, CO_2, which makes up more than two-third of GHGs. If CO_2 emissions can be reduced significantly, there is a likelihood that the world can achieve a net-zero carbon emissions goal.

Second, particulate matter 2.5 ($PM_{2.5}$), which is the largest and most damaging pollutant today. If $PM_{2.5}$ can be reduced substantially, the problem of environmental pollution would largely disappear.

Third, ozone (O). Surface ozone, the result of nitrogen oxides chemically reacting with organic matter, is a major health hazard. Ozone that escapes to the ozonosphere causes a hole in the ozone layer. To tackle ozone, one has to fix the problem of nitrogen oxides as well.

Fourth, burning solid fuels in households is the primary reason for indoor pollution and also contributes to release of CO_2.

Fifth, discharge of untreated sewage in the commons: water bodies or land.

If India can manage these five polluting elements without compromising on the production of goods and services, GDP or national income, the quality of life of residents will improve tremendously and the country will also play its rightful role in solving the problem of climate change.